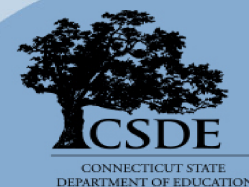


Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2021–22



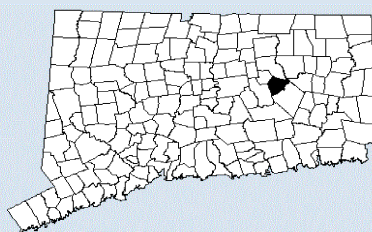
Columbia School District

Maria Geryk, Superintendent • 860-228-9493 • <http://www.hwporter.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-8
Number of Schools/Programs	1
Enrollment	442
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$20,219
Total Expenditures ¹	\$12,778,242

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2020-21 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2021-22 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2021 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	203	45.9	48.5
Male	239	54.1	51.5
Non-Binary	0	0.0	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	*	*	5.1
Black or African American	*	*	12.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	38	8.6	29.0
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	16	3.6	4.3
White	378	85.5	48.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	8.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	96	21.7	40.6
Students with Disabilities ³	54	12.2	16.7

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	15	7.7	*	*
Male	17	7.8	*	*
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	0	*	0	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	*	*	*	*
White	26	7.4	23	5.9
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	10	11.1	10	10.0
Students with Disabilities	8	15.7	10	14.3
District	32	7.7	27	5.9
State		23.7		6.5

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 0

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Columbia School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	38.3
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	15.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	3.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	14.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	2.0
School Level	2.0
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	1.0
Support Staff	0.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	4.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	3.0
School Nurses	1.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	31.0

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	0	0.0	1.3
Black or African American	0	0.0	4.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	1	1.9	4.6
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.2
White	52	98.1	89.2

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2020-21

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	4.2	10.4

Instruction and Resources

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers²

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	*	*
Emotional Disturbance	*	*
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	27	93.1
Other Health Impairment	20	95.2
Other Disabilities	0	0
Speech/Language Impairment	6	*
District	60	87.0
State		68.4

² This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Columbia School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	6	0.9	2.3
Emotional Disturbance	*	*	1.1
Intellectual Disability	*	*	0.6
Learning Disability	29	4.6	6.1
Other Health Impairment	21	3.3	3.3
Other Disabilities	*	*	1.1
Speech/Language Impairment	7	1.1	1.9
All Disabilities	71	11.2	16.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	*	*	8.2
Private Schools or Other Settings	*	*	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2020-21

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$7,658,786	\$12,118	\$12,000
Support services - students	\$2,217,519	\$5,544	\$1,468
Support services - instruction	\$113,444	\$284	\$780
Support services - general administration	\$604,439	\$1,511	\$472
Support services - school based administration	\$580,242	\$1,451	\$1,103
Central and other support services	\$135,068	\$338	\$703
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$437,397	\$1,093	\$1,910
Student transportation services	\$656,562	\$1,073	\$1,287
Food services	.	.	\$28
Enterprise operations	\$374,786	\$937	\$170
Total	\$12,778,242	\$20,219	\$19,134

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2020-21

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$920,984	31.3	29.7
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$282,950	9.6	10.8
Other Salaries	\$276,266	9.4	9.8
Employee Benefits	\$436,364	14.8	13.8
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$124,579	4.2	5.7
Special Education Tuition	\$769,398	26.2	22.6
Supplies	\$14,265	0.5	0.6
Property Services	.	.	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$107,424	3.7	6.3
Equipment	\$6,165	0.2	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$250	0.0	0.1
Total	\$2,938,645	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		23.0	24.5

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2020-21

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	79.0
State	18.2
Federal	2.5
Tuition & Other	0.2

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Columbia School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Asian	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Black or African American	*	*	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	30	71.8	30	65.3	11	*
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A
Two or More Races	8	*	8	*	*	*
White	227	68.5	226	64.0	76	70.3
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*	*	*
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	*	*	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	57	61.4	57	58.5	17	*
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	213	70.2	212	65.3	75	72.7
Students with Disabilities	37	53.6	37	48.9	17	*
Students without Disabilities	233	70.7	232	66.2	75	73.2
High Needs	86	59.1	86	55.7	31	55.8
Non-High Needs	184	72.7	183	67.7	61	76.6
District	270	68.4	269	63.8	92	69.6

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at

https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	98.1	100.0	97.9	N/A	140	98.6
Curl Up	96.2	85.4	89.4	N/A	140	90.7
Push Up	98.1	95.1	91.5	N/A	140	95.0
Mile Run/PACER	86.5	75.6	76.6	N/A	140	80.0
All Tests - District	86.5	75.6	76.6	N/A	140	80.0
All Tests - State	48.9	46.7	44.3	43.3		45.8

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Columbia School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	68.4	75	45.6	50	91.1	64.2
	High Needs Students	59.1	75	39.4	50	78.9	54.2
Math Performance Index	All Students	63.8	75	42.6	50	85.1	58.6
	High Needs Students	55.7	75	37.1	50	74.2	47.7
Science Performance Index	All Students	69.6	75	46.4	50	92.8	61.4
	High Needs Students	55.8	75	37.2	50	74.4	51.3
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	59.6%	100%	59.6	100	59.6	60.4%
	High Needs Students	56.3%	100%	56.3	100	56.3	56.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	78.7%	100%	78.7	100	78.7	65.2%
	High Needs Students	76.2%	100%	76.2	100	76.2	59.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	.	100%	.	.	.	64.9%
	Oral	.	100%	.	.	.	57.4%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	7.7%	<=5%	44.5	50	89.0	23.7%
	High Needs Students	11.4%	<=5%	37.2	50	74.5	34.0%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	.	75%	.	.	.	84.8%
	% Meeting Benchmark	.	75%	.	.	.	43.5%
On-track to High School Graduation		88.4%	94%	47.0	50	94.0	82.7%
4-year Graduation All Students (2021 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	89.6%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2019 Cohort)		.	94%	.	.	.	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2021)		.	75%	.	.	.	66.1%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		97.2% 80.0%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	94.0% 45.8%
Arts Access		.	60%	.	.	.	52.4%
Accountability Index				697.8	900	77.5	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					Y
ELA Performance Index Gap	72.7	59.1	13.5	16.6	
Math Performance Index Gap	67.7	55.7	12.0	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	75.0	55.8	19.2	17.4	
Graduation Rate Gap	.	.	.	.	

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	96.5
	High Needs Students	94.6
Math	All Students	96.5
	High Needs Students	94.6
Science	All Students	94.9
	High Needs Students	91.2

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: * **State: 49.7**

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Columbia School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Columbia School District and Horace W. Porter School are dedicated to the continuous improvement of our multi-tiered system of educational programming provided to all students. The district improvement plan outlines the mission, vision, core values and guiding principles established by the broader educational community and provides a road map to meet these expectations. Through analysis of multiple data points and progress to date, the plan is modified yearly to adapt and adjust to the changing student needs. The goal areas and strategies identified focus on strengthening the systems and structures essential to provide embedded professional development; strengthening and aligning a model of high-quality instruction, standards-based curriculum, assessment, and interventions; to create a comprehensive framework to ensure a positive learning environment and to improve school-wide climate; and strengthening two-way communication with staff, students, families and the broader community. The continuous improvement plan drives all initiatives and the budget process.

Renewal of curricular programs aligned with the Common Core State Standards continues as a priority for Porter School. Evidence-based programs are being implemented to meet the needs of our students in the area of mathematics, English Language Arts, science, health, and technology. Review of social studies curricular needs are underway. In addition, focus is maintained to strengthen our Scientific Research-Based Instruction Model, including the routine application of a student support team process where academic, social, emotional, attendance, and behavioral needs are reviewed and interventions prescribed. Essential to continuous improvement, instructional coaches and interventionists are in place for Porter School.

We are entering our fourth year of implementation of a school-wide approach to positive behavioral intervention and support. In addition, we are entering our third year of implementation of a social emotional learning curriculum taught at all grade levels.

Our commitment is to meet the needs of all Columbia students. Special education services are provided for those identified students based on their individual needs. We currently maintain one full-day, integrated preschool and two half-day programs. A broad range of service providers and specialists are in place to provide identified specialized instruction in the least restrictive setting.

Increasing systemic family engagement continues to be a priority for Columbia. While there is a strong Porter Parent Organization in place, leveraging family input and student voice to inform school improvement efforts is an area of focus. Various methods of sharing information through the use of Facebook, newsletters, routine updates, school messenger, and the launch of a new website are in place.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Columbia School District is focusing on efforts to reduce racial, ethnic and economic isolation by striving to provide an equitable school district for all students. We are actively exploring and addressing barriers to equitable student access, participation, and benefit to programs and services. Data is analyzed to identify and address achievement gaps in academic performance, discipline data, and attendance.

We are strengthening our instructional practices, interventions, and enrichment. Curricular materials are chosen to ensure they are effective with our student populations, and that material and content are representative of students in our global world. For example, the district adopted a new ELA program. Cultural representation and relevance were strong considerations in our selection process, and the new program integrates global perspectives, and a diverse range of authors and texts. We also began redesigning our middle school Social Studies curriculum, with increased cultural relevance as one of our goals in this work.

Porter School is dedicated to cultivating an understanding and respect for diverse populations, abilities, and perspectives. Implementation of a school-wide approach to positive behavioral intervention and support is a framework that provides a strong foundation so that all students understand and learn the school and classroom expectations.

Porter continues to partner with Canton High School to provide middle school students experiences centered on positive self-esteem. In addition, Porter school staff and other area providers (AHM Youth and Family Services) create opportunities for our students to learn and apply skills in problem solving, restorative processes, leadership, mentoring, empathy, and respect. This past year, AHM brought in a facilitator to address issues related to stress and peer relationships for our grade eight students. In addition, the "Wingman Experience" was brought in for our students in grades six and seven to provide activities to foster empathy and empower people with the belief that they matter. Finally, SERC (State Education Resource Center) conducted focus groups with our focus groups our grade five students to address topics of identity, culture, race, bias, and equity.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Columbia School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

Columbia is a single-school preschool through grade 8 district that provides for students in grades 9-12 to attend three high schools (Bolton, EO Smith and Windham Tech.) based solely on choice. Resources are allocated based on where students chose to attend school and, therefore, are fixed costs for our district.

Classroom teachers and other professionals develop budget requests for Porter School which are submitted to administration. After administrative and BOE review, the approved budget is reviewed by the town's finance board. The recommended budget is presented at an Annual Town meeting for approval. The Board of Education goals represented through the Continuous Improvement Plan are the basis for budget development and implementation.